

PCTFREE and PCTUSED

- o PCTFREE and PCTUSED are storage parameters in Oracle.
- o Used to manage space allocation in data blocks.
- o Influence how Oracle manages free space in data block and when it considers a block to be "full".

PCTFREE: (Percentage of free space)

Def: Specifies the percentage of space in data blocks to be reserved for future updates.

⇒ how much space should be left in a database block for future updates.

- o When a block is created or extended, it ensures that at least this percentage of the block remains free.

- o Default value is 10% but can be adjusted based on requirements.

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⇒ Also allows for efficient space utilization when rows are updated and expanded.

PCTUSED (Percentage of block used)

- Specifies the percentage of ~~rows~~ data block that must be used before it is considered for insertion of new rows.
- when the used space in a block falls below this threshold, Oracle marks the block as available for new data.
- Default value is 40%.
- Allows insertion of new rows into partially filled blocks.

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Q. Define data-chaining and data migration?

Oracle inserts multiple rows into single data block.

Data chaining

⇒ if a row size is larger than data block size.

Data migration

⇒ if a row is inserted small and updated and there is no space left in data block

Data chaining is unavoidable. Oracle tries to prevent data migration.

Q. How to control free space in the block?

⇒ By using two parameters.

- PCTFREE
- PCTUSED

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Q. How to load data into database?

⇒ Loading data into an Oracle database involves several steps and can be done using different tools and methods such as:

- SQL* Loader
 - Oracle data pump — Utility
 - ↳ high speed data movement & metadata
 - Direct SQL commands.
- Prepare control file & load them.